What I've learned from Waterlust

Launching your passion project while in graduate school
(and turning it into a career...hopefully)

motivation

define your idea

it's not about you

find soulmates

establish your audience

leverage opportunity

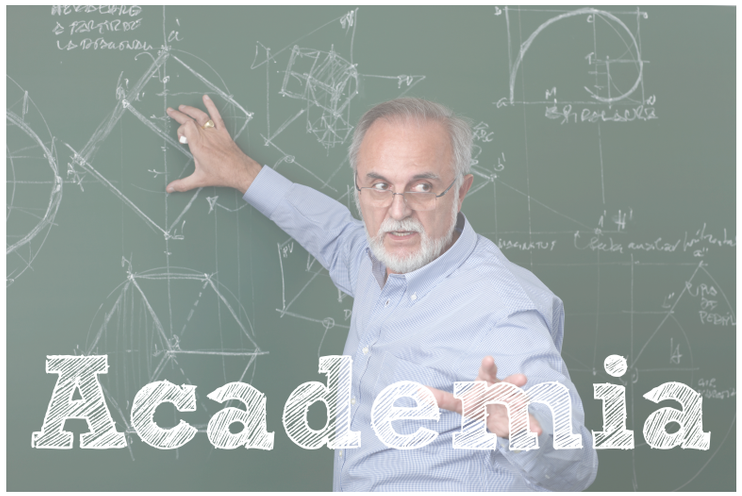
business model

grow

Motivation

Studenthood

Career



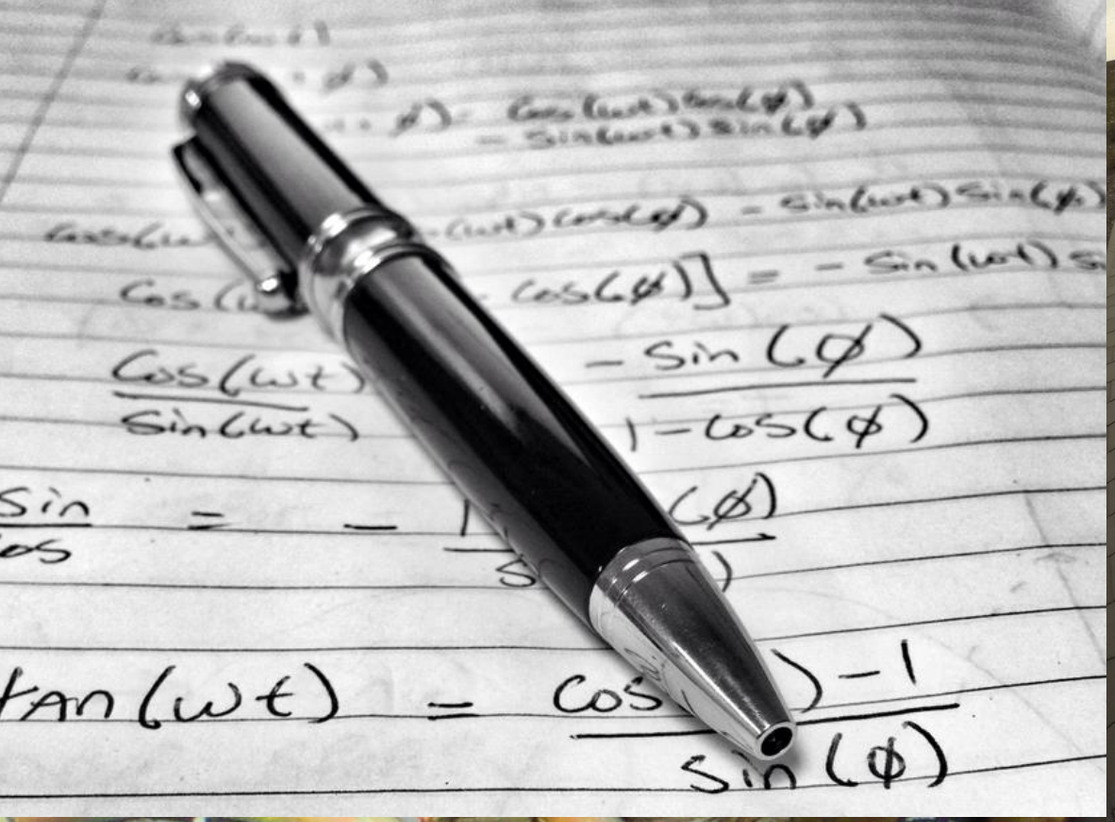
Reasons to come to grad school

You want to learn more

Contribute to knowledge

Strategic career positioning

Nothing better to do



your student work is likely very specialized

Motivation

A passion project can help bridge the gap between what you're doing in school and what you want to do after school.

The Distraction Dilemma

A never ending life battle

Keep boss in the loop

A supportive advisor makes life MUCH easier

Get your school work done!

Graduate school is a job

Balance your responsibilities and don't forget to enjoy life

Define your idea

Why do this

Will I enjoy it

Where to start

Risk/Reward

Something you truly believe in your soul

It's a marathon not a sprint.

Build on your talents

Keep the stakes low at first

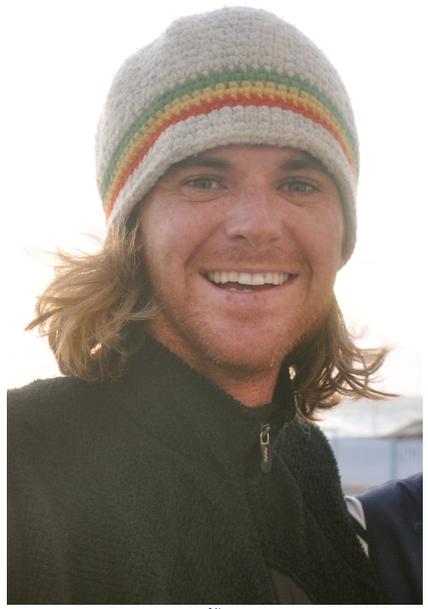
2011
Waterlust is born

To engage a global audience about marine science topics in exciting and creative ways

Why do this	**There is a need for better science communication**
Will I enjoy it	**Scratch the creative itch that isn't happening in research**
Where to start	**I like making videos**
Risk/Reward	**Don't risk my PhD** **Get to learn new skills**

It is not about you

The Patrick Project



Pros

Ego stroking

Brand yourself

Cons

Appears self serving

Don't die!

Doesn't feel like a team

End game?

Nobody cares about you

vs.

Waterlust

Pros

Team feels ownership

Protectable

Create a community

Sellable

Cons

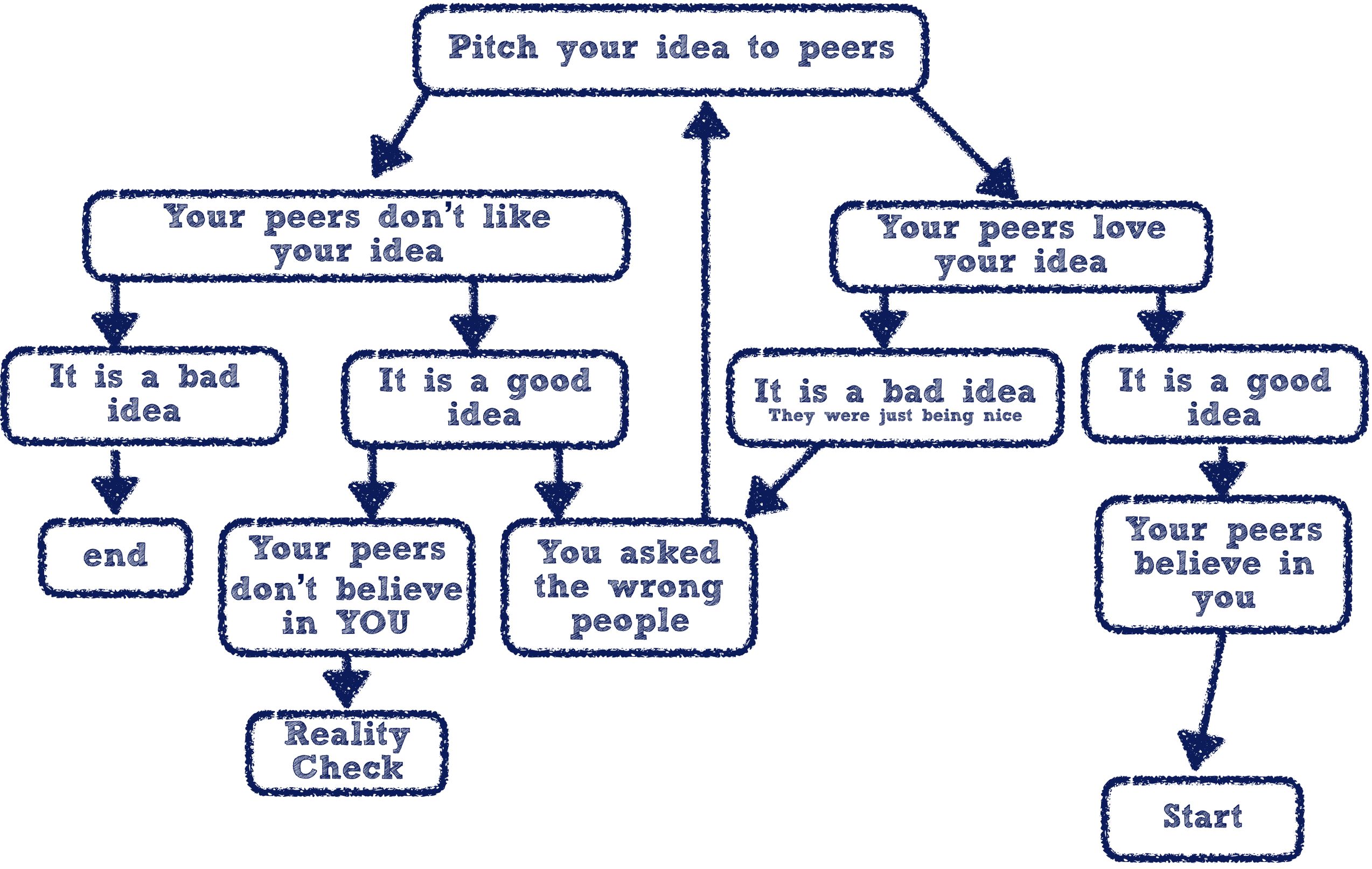
Can take time to find a great name

Starting with nothing

Less recognition

Keep that ego in check

Reality check flow chart



find soulmates

Waterlust

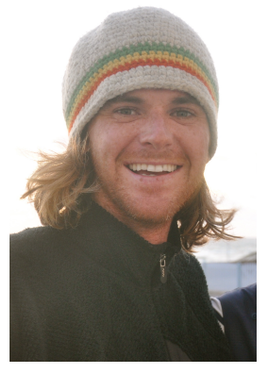
Alumni bring an innovative concept to conservation through filmmaking and apparel.

Waterlust began as an experimental project by Patrick Rynne, Ph.D. '16, and Fiona Rynne, B.S.M.A.S. '10, M.S. '13, at the University of Miami's Rosenstiel School of Marine and Atmospheric Science. Seeking to change the paradigm on conventional methods of sharing scientific findings with the world, their early days were spent learning how to use online media to engage the public with marine science in an entertaining, fun and informative way.

Form a team of people that believe in you and your idea

This is your first lesson in management and leadership.

Don't forget



vs.

establish your audience

Audience Size

Friends
Family
Colleagues
} Drive initial growth

Do: Ask for honest feedback
Dont: Force them to like it

Your Peers

Time

Pay CLOSE attention to feedback and adjust quickly.

Robotic Shark

39,288 views

62 27 SHARE SAVE

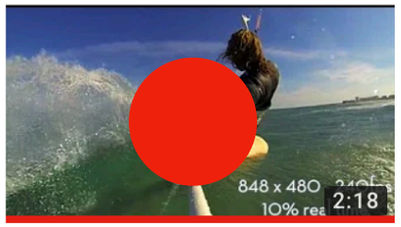
Kite vs Moth vs 49er

229,325 views

767 30 SHARE SAVE

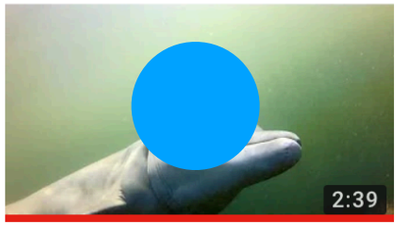
"that was boring"

"that was awesome"



GoPro Slow Motion Tips

59K views • 5 years ago

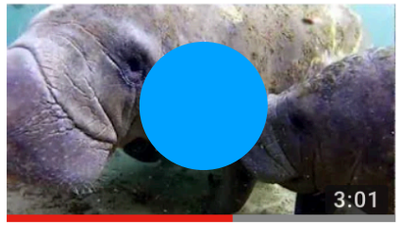


Why do dolphins look at you with both eyes?

34K views • 5 years ago

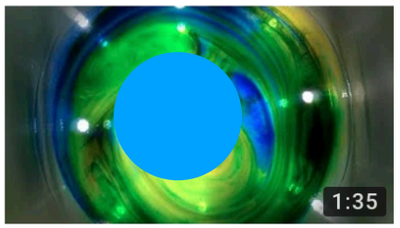
Jumping into a frozen lake....for CHARITY!

22K views • 5 years ago



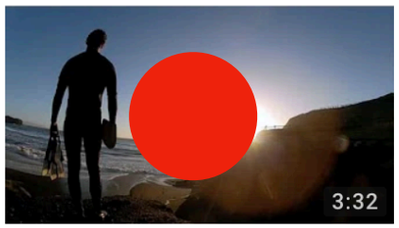
Want to become a marine scientist?

26K views • 5 years ago



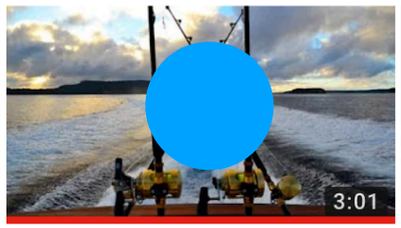
Coriolis - Why hurricanes spin

15K views • 5 years ago



Swells and Storms - Mike Gibbons

23K views • 5 years ago



Moneyfi$h - A Waterlust Film about Billfish

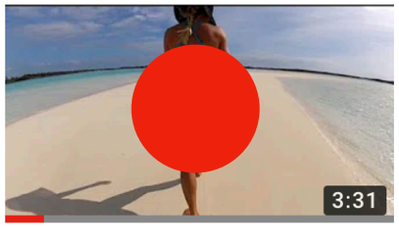
52K views • 6 years ago

Tandem kitesurfing on a skimboard!

2K views • 6 years ago

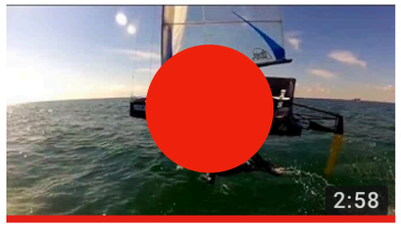
Coastguards - A Waterlust Film about Sharks

29K views • 6 years ago



Azul - A Waterlust film about women in water

336K views • 6 years ago

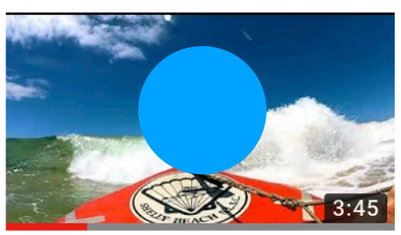


Lift - A Waterlust Film about Hydrofoils

89K views • 6 years ago

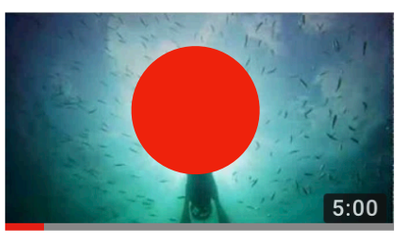
Woodsled - A Waterlust film about kiting the Alaia

67K views • 6 years ago



Something everybody should know about Rip Currents!

181K views • 6 years ago



Our first ever Waterlust video!

133K views • 6 years ago

Science

Adventure

We learned early that adventure content was popular

But science content was meaningful

Don't sacrifice your soul

Azul - A Waterlust film about women in water

336,728 views

1.5K 69 SHARE SAVE

Always remind yourself why you exist

GoPro Featuring Our Content

Symbiotic Business Relationships

What you need

GoPro
Be a HERO.

Exposure

Creativity

Legitimacy

Authenticity

Money

Cheap marketing material

Symbiotic Business Relationships

What you have

GoPro
Be a HERO.

New ideas

Blank Canvas

No idea what your effort is worth

Massive Audience

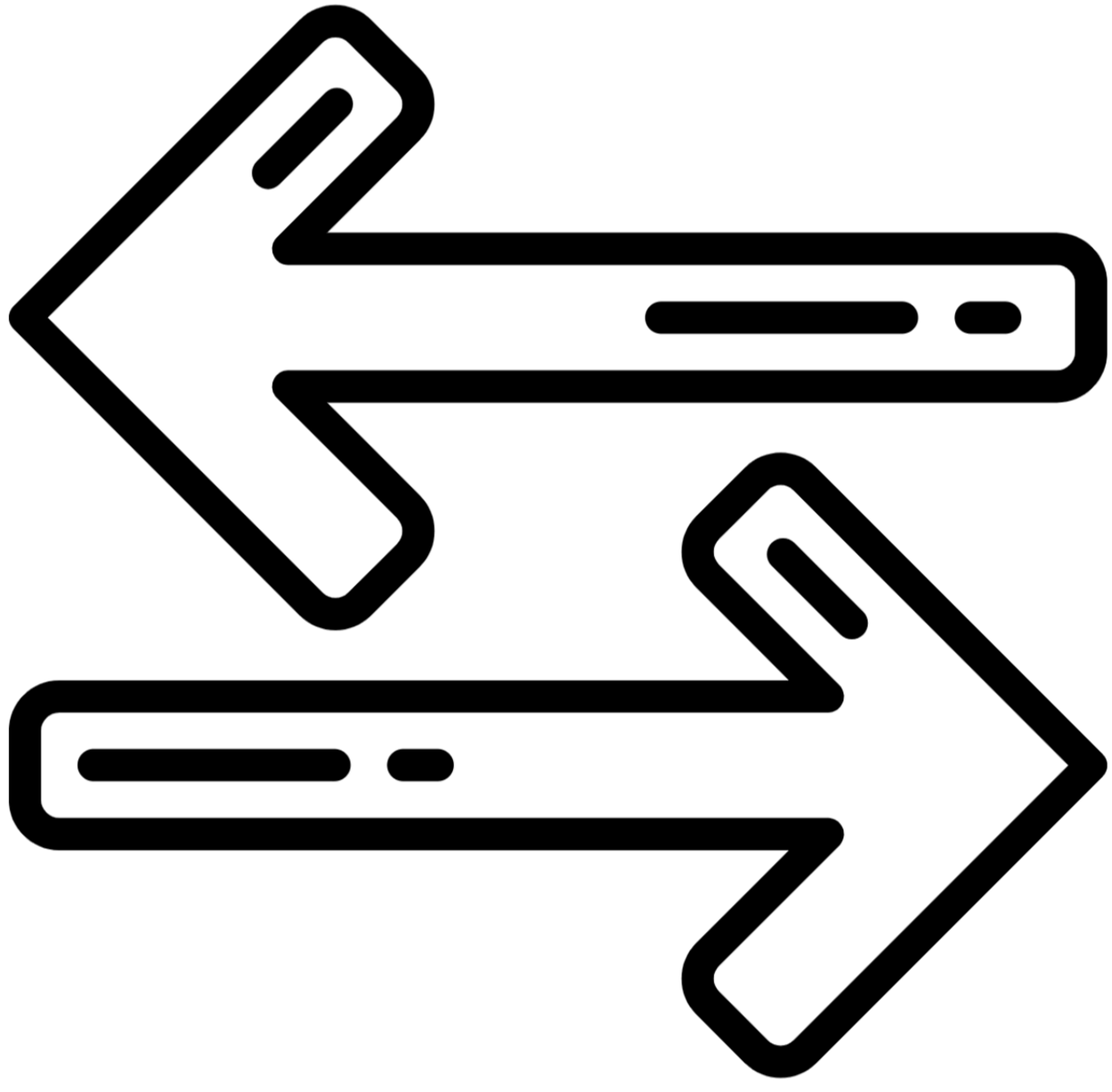
Established Reputation

Lots of money

The give and take

What you need

What they Can give



What you Can give

What they Need

The give and take

Value of Request

AND Stress Level

Our Race to Alaska - A Waterlust Film

79,166 views

602 13 SHARE SAVE ...

10,000 miles later - A Review of our DIY Teardrop Camper

Drones at the beach - A Waterlust film about the SCOPE experiment

66,960 views

98 1 SHARE SAVE ...

Something everybody should know about Rip Currents!

181,095 views

593 12 SHARE SAVE ...

Reputation

Good relationships lead to more relationships

Birth

GoPro
Be a HERO.

Audience Growth

SPERRY
Since 1935

Funding

Grow your Brand

Brand Building

GRAIN SURFBOARDS · CTEK · xantrex · VMAX CHARGE TANK · ARB 4X4 ACCESSORIES
BIG kahuna PORTABLE SHOWER · CHESAPEAKE LIGHT CRAFT · DOUGLAS FOWLER SAILMAKER · TOTALBOAT · Syrp
CABRINHA · NEILPRYDE · IMAGINE PADDLE SURF CO. · ADVENTURE SPORTS · RAW ELEMENTS
COSTA · SAILRITE · wegener · GOPOLE · CRESSI
SRP SNAKE RIVER PROTOTYPING · FIREWIRE · SUUNTO

Audience Growth

Grow your Brand

Flower Anemone Reversible Top
$42

Whale Shark Warrior Reversible Top
$42

Tiger Shark Trailblazer Reversible Top
$42

Sun-Kissed Sea Reversible Top
$42

leverage opportunity

But stay balanced

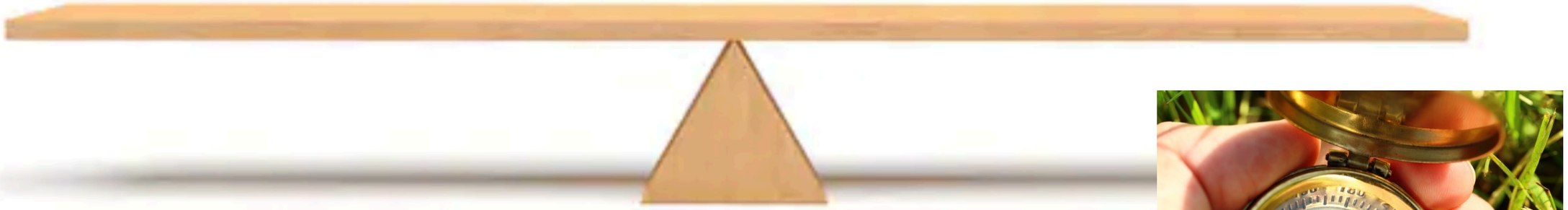
Opportunity Today

GoPro
Be a HERO.

SPERRY
Since 1935

Your overall mission

Something you truly believe in your soul



Opportunity Today

Your mission

Slow Growth

Your mission

Opportunity Today

Lost in the woods

Business Model

That annoying thing you need to survive

Your idea

Non Profit

Service

Product

Advocate Apparel Concept

DEBRIS FREE OCEANS

MARINE MEGAFAUNA FOUNDATION
CONSERVATION THROUGH RESEARCH WWW.MARINEMEGAFAUNA.ORG

SHARK
RESEARCH & CONSERVATION

Use clothing as a science communication tool

Dhigurah

vaimititeivamoana The r
love and conserve our wi
@m.w.s.r.p #iru #fenupar
#whaleshark #research #
#conservation #reef #oc
#maldives

oceanstories_ I spy ama
shark leggings!

59 likes

5 HOURS AGO

Add a comment...

physioshark • Follow
Pihaena, French Polynesia

physioshark Yes, Gail is about to put that shark in a cooler...

But it's no picnic! This juvenile black tip reef shark will be in @rummerlab swimming in fresh, oxygenated water in little more than an hour. Maximum.
Though sharks are abundant here, we always consider their wellbeing. French Polynesia is an unrivalled study site where the population supports meaningful data...

But it's also hot, and we gotta keep our babies cool!

📸 of @gschwiety, collecting sharks for some fascinating shark blood studies. Read more about her research on our recent Facebook Post.

196 likes

NOVEMBER 23

Add a comment...

girlsthatfreedive When your leggings match your favourite animal!! @waterlust #girlsthatfreedive 🤰♀ @islandkey_ . 📸 @dante_fla .

View all 43 comments

ziadfathalla @ahmedellakany fagra

ahmedellakany @ziadfathalla 😍 😍

pameichigomymelody 😍 awesome photo 👏

fadi_alhusini 👍 👍 👍 👌 💪

predatorpaintballandlaser I am SOOO JEALOUS

chiarabarrasso Amazing💙

wanderlost__couple Woow🍗

domwere 😍

fragrantspringkat7921 Incredible

proctomed 😬 😍

3,970 likes

NOVEMBER 19

Add a comment...

francescaapage • Following

francescaapage Messy studio 🤦 How it's always gonna be! I like to think I work in organised mess 💥 There is 24hrs left to order a custom painting, ends tomorrow mid night! So don't miss out 🙏 Also will be doing a 15% #blackfriday sale off prints and #apparel tomorrow till Sunday! My first Black Friday of many I hope 🏊 Sale starts tomorrow morning 💥 Now back to painting I go, Lots of ocean love, F x

🐋🐳🐬 www.francescapageart.com 🐬🐠🐟

2,008 likes

NOVEMBER 22

ster @fernietow y mi sobrinito Pako for the best introduction to the i
peninsula. Volveré pronto
.
.
.
#baja #peninsula #mexic
#playasbonitas #waterlus
#loscabos #seasters #av

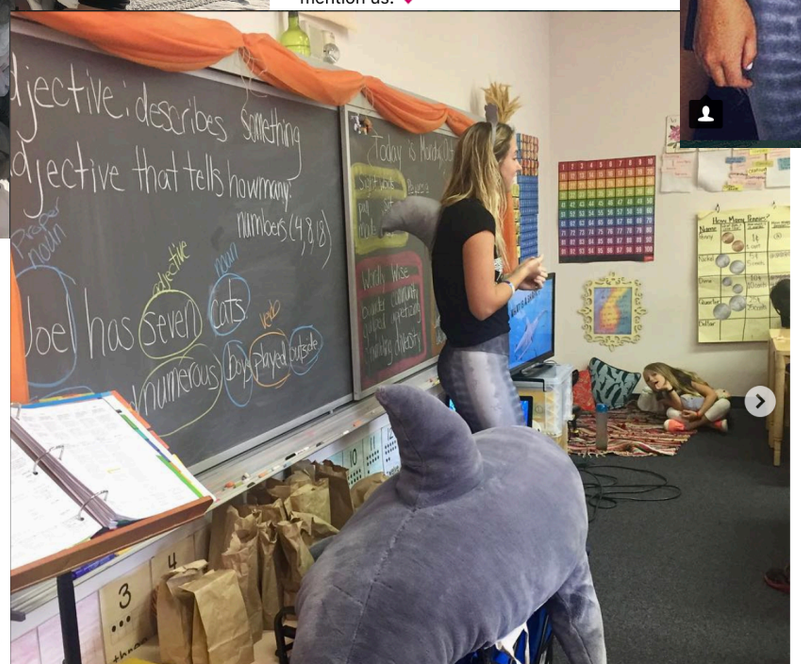
weneedtosaveoceans h
DM us?🦈

caillacakes • Follow
Jacksonville Beach Pier

caillacakes us shark are rendered USELESS! USELESS I TELL YOU to single use plastics!🦈 •🎃👻🦈👽🤠 Dress up and WIN prizes this Sunday, October 28 at the Jax Beach Pier! Sign up with link in my bio 🎃👻

waterlust Love this!!! You look great! 💙

teamsinceresallyboutique Hey Cailla 🙌 We would love to have you on our team! DM @sinceresallyboutique and mention us! 💗



seek.to.sea.more • Follow
Key Largo, Florida

seek.to.sea.more Thanks @darylduda5 for the picture of me doing what I truly love to do 💦

seek.to.sea.more .
.
.
.
.
.
#scubadiving #snorkel #keylargo
#conservation #rainbowreef
#divekeylargo #travel #wanderlust

students of Seaside Charter about SHARKS! 🦈 One student told me that I helped her get over her fear of sharks! The power of education and awareness is SO powerful💪 The students even had the chance to be shark biologists and work up a shark just like we do on the research boat! 🦈🏊 Message me if you want @sharkeducation in your classroom!🦈🍗 #sharks4kids #savesharks #sharkseducation #outreach

biggreig11 Aw miss my days of teaching kids about the sea!

kylarei My dog wears that fin in the shop 🖤🦈

biminisharkgirl 💙 💙 💙

flowersandbutterflies4401 Come to my school sissy

melodypendy You were so great! They

Your overall mission

Something you truly believe in your soul

Do these align?

Business model

Grow

Annual Revenue

2015

2016

2017

2018

Buy a camera

Fund some video projects

Buy office supplies

Get health insurance

Hire accountant

Get a lawyer

Advertise

Plan ahead

Expand the team

Take on new projects

Open HQ

HR?

Line of credit

Wholesale

Budget for Projects

Do bigger Projects

Work full time

Hire Employees

Growing pains can kill you

1 million

100,000

1 million in cash
10+ employees
Wholesale Distribution
500k donations

10,000

100k cash
6 employees
50k donations

1000 Units
per year

30k cash
3 employees

Online only
5k donations

"Every company is 60-90 days away from being bankrupt"

Something you truly believe in your soul

Questions